

Proposal for Emoji: Kidney

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Identification

Suggested name: Kidney

Suggested keywords: renal; anatomy; organ; filtration; urine; hydration; dialysis; transplant; donation; stone; bean-shaped

Suggested category: People & Body - body-parts

Suggested sort location: Near anatomical heart, lungs, and brain in the body-parts subgroup.

Required Example Images

Size	Color	Black and white
18x18		
72x72		

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Factors for Inclusion

A. Multiple meanings

Not applicable. The proposal does not rely on a pun, metaphor, or secondary meaning.

B. Use in sequences

Kidney can combine with existing emoji to create additional messages:

- Kidney + droplet: kidney function or urine production.
- Kidney + hospital: kidney care or treatment.
- Kidney + test tube: kidney testing.

NIDDK documents kidney function, urine production, and kidney care in [Your Kidneys & How They Work](#) and [Choosing a Treatment for Kidney Failure](#). MedlinePlus documents blood and urine testing in [Kidney Tests](#).

C. Breaks new ground

Yes. The [current Unicode Emoji List](#) has no kidney or urinary-system organ. Beans express food, and a droplet or hospital expresses fluid or care, but none clearly identifies the kidney. Kidney adds the organ itself as a broad communicative building block for anatomy, function, testing, donation, transplantation, dialysis, and related care.

D. Distinctiveness

Kidney is shown as two maroon, bean-shaped organs with inward-facing indentations, a slight vertical offset, and short central vessel and ureter cues. At 18 pixels, the inward-facing indentations and shared central anatomy distinguish it from Beans, whose separate pieces have no anatomical connection, and from Lungs, whose lobes join an airway from above. Vendors may vary shading and plumbing detail while keeping the paired inward-facing forms, vertical offset, and short central cues.

E. Expected usage level

Kidney has broad, durable use across anatomy and physiology, urine production, testing, dialysis, transplantation, living donation, and medication review. These uses are documented by [NIDDK's kidney-function overview](#), [NIDDK's kidney-failure treatment guide](#), [NIDDK's transplant guide](#), and [MedlinePlus Kidney Tests](#). The five required frequency exhibits below use the unfiltered term kidney; Google Trends and Google Books compare it with elephant.

Google Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Web Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 211,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Search query.](#)

kidney

AI Mode

All

Images

Videos

Shopping

News

Short videos

More

Tools

AI Overview

Kidneys are **two bean-shaped organs, about the size of a fist, located on either side of the spine just below the rib cage.** They filter roughly 37 gallons of blood daily to remove waste and extra water, maintaining fluid, salt, and mineral balance while producing urine. Key functions also include regulating blood pressure, stimulating red blood cell production, and managing bone health. [Cleveland Clinic](#) +4

Key Kidney Functions & Health

- Filtration:** Using millions of tiny units called nephrons, kidneys filter waste and excess water from the blood, which then travels to the bladder through ureters.

Show more

Cleveland Clinic

<https://my.clevelandclinic.org/body/21824-kidney>

Kidneys: Location, Anatomy, Function & Health

Nov 5, 2025 — Your kidneys are organs that filter your blood. They remove waste and balance your body's fluids, among other tasks. Most people have one kidney ... [Read more](#)

National Kidney Foundation

National Kidney Foundation

Kidney Disease At-a-Glance. Image. 1 in 3 adults in the U.S. are at risk for kidney disease. Image. 90K people...

National Kidney Foundation

Kidney Disease - NIDDK

The kidneys are two bean-shaped organs. Each kidney is about the size of a fist. Your kidneys filter extra wat...

National Institutes of Health (gov)

Kidney Disease - NIDDK

The kidneys are two bean-shaped organs. Each kidney is about the size of a fist. Your kidneys filter extra wat...

People also ask

What are the first signs of a kidney problem?

What is the best drink to flush your kidneys?

What are the three early warning signs of a kidney?

What drinks are hardest on the kidneys?

3 of 8

Google Video Search

Captured 2026-05-13 in signed-out Google Video Search with English-language results and no date or country filter selected. The page reports about 66,000,000 indexed results. [Open the reproducible Google Video Search query.](#)

The screenshot shows the Google Video Search interface. The search bar contains the word "kidney". Below the search bar, there are navigation tabs: "All Mode", "All", "Images", "News", "Videos" (which is selected), "Shopping", "Books", "More", and "Tools". To the right of the search bar, there are icons for settings, a grid, and a "Sign in" button. Below the navigation tabs, there are several video results. Each result includes a thumbnail, a title, a description, and the source. A dropdown menu is open on the right side of the page, showing filters for "Any duration", "Any time", "Any quality", "All videos", "Any source", and "Advanced Search". At the bottom of the dropdown menu, it says "About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)".

Google kidney

AI Mode All Images News **Videos** Shopping Books More Tools

www.youtube.com › watch
How Do Kidneys Work?
For more information about the function of kidneys, please see <https://cle.clinic/3RCqSr3> Your kidneys are your body's cle...
YouTube · Cleveland Clinic · Jun 19, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch
Get to Know Your Kidneys
Did you know your kidneys filter all of your blood up to 25 times a day? No matter your age, or whether you have kidney disease, getting to ...
YouTube · National Institute of Diabetes and Digestive and Kidney Diseases (NIDDK) · Feb 26, 2024

www.youtube.com › watch
Kidney Function
KidneyFunction #RenalFunction #UrineProduction This is a repost of a video from 2024 to test the new YouTube auto dubbing feature, ...
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · Apr 29, 2025

www.youtube.com › watch
How Your Kidneys Work
MEDICAL ANIMATION TRANSCRIPT: The kidneys are located on either side of the spinal column in the posterior abdominal wall.
YouTube · Nucleus Medical Media · May 16, 2024

www.mayoclinic.org › multimedia › vid-20207497
How kidneys work
How kidneys work — Animation shows how kidneys filter blood, removing waste and extra fluid, which are then carried out of the body in urine.
Mayo Clinic · Mayo Clinic · Mar 25, 2021

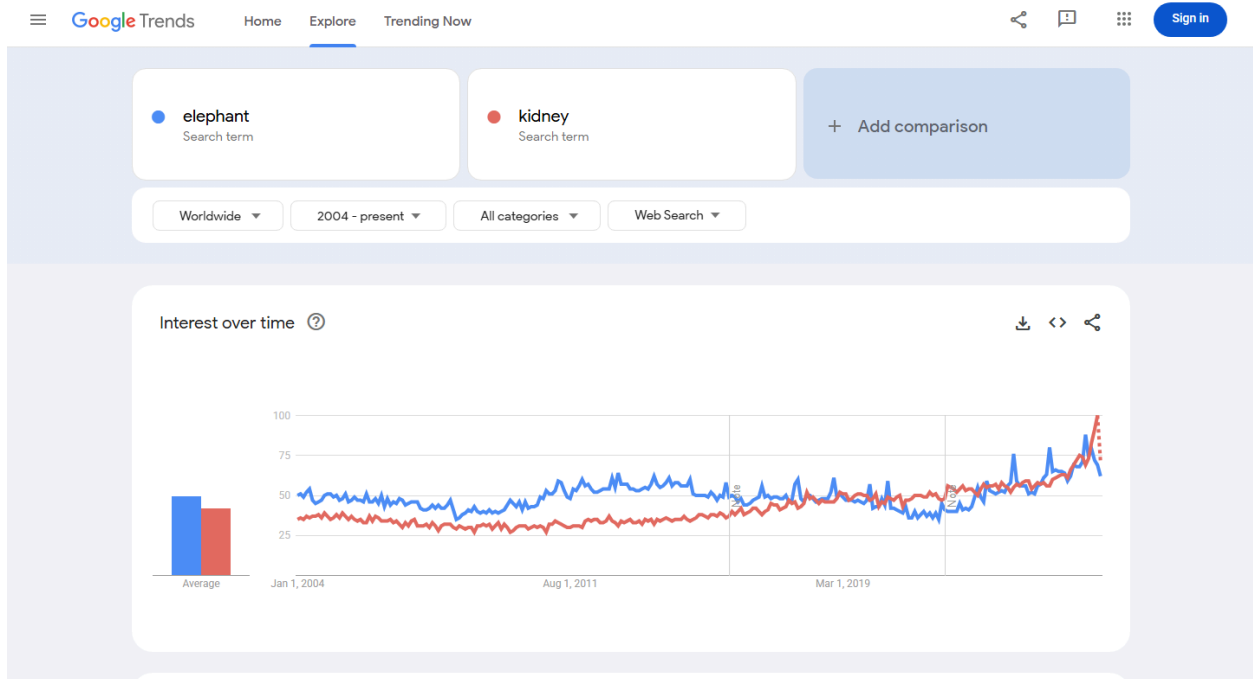
www.youtube.com › watch
Mayo Clinic Explains Kidney Disease
Learning about kidney disease can be intimidating. Let our experts walk you through the facts, the questions, and the answers to help you ...
YouTube · Mayo Clinic · Dec 16, 2021

Any duration
Any time
Any quality
All videos
Any source
Advanced Search

About 66,000,000 results (0.18s)

Google Trends - Web Search

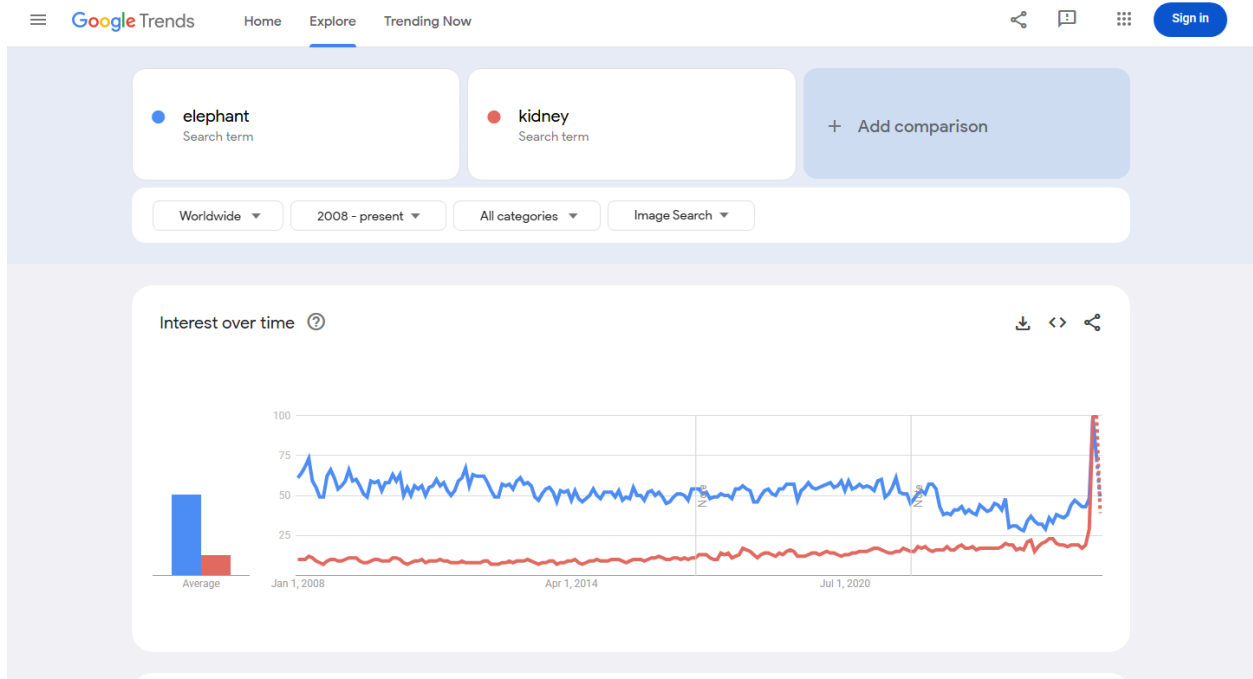
Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2004-present, All categories, and Web Search. Elephant has the higher historical average; kidney remains sustained and reaches comparable or greater interest in recent periods. [Open the reproducible Google Trends Web Search query.](#)



Google Trends - Image Search

Captured 2026-05-13 using Worldwide, 2008-present, All categories, and Image Search. Kidney shows sustained image-search interest but remains below elephant for most of the displayed range.

[Open the reproducible Google Trends Image Search query.](#)



Google Books Ngram Viewer

Captured 2026-07-09 using the English corpus, 1500-2022, and smoothing 3. Kidney exceeds elephant in recent published-book usage. [Open the reproducible Google Books Ngram query](#).



F. Completeness

Not applicable. Kidney is independently useful and is not proposed merely to complete a set of organs.

G. Compatibility

Not applicable. This proposal does not rely on a legacy carrier emoji or another encoded pictograph.

Factors for Exclusion

A. Already representable

Beans, or Beans combined with a hospital, can suggest food, diet, or kidney care, but the result remains ambiguous between food and anatomy. A droplet or medical emoji can express fluid or care but cannot identify the organ. Kidney would clearly identify the organ in discussions of function, testing, donation, transplantation, dialysis, and related care documented by [NIDDK](#) and [MedlinePlus](#).

B. Overly specific

Kidney represents the organ generally across anatomy, function, testing, donation, transplantation, dialysis, and related care. It is not a particular disease, procedure, specialty, organization, campaign, brand, or subtype of an existing organ emoji.

C. Open-ended

Encoding Kidney would not automatically justify Liver, Stomach, Pancreas, Spleen, or every other organ. Each candidate must independently demonstrate expected use, a meaning that existing emoji cannot express clearly, and a legible visual identity. Kidney is proposed only on that independent evidence, not to begin or complete an anatomy set.

D. Transient

Kidney is an established anatomical term rather than a campaign, event, or product. The embedded Google Books evidence spans 1500-2022, and current [NIDDK kidney guidance](#) documents continuing anatomical and care uses.

E. Faulty comparison

This proposal does not depend on Heart, Lungs, or Brain being encoded. Kidney's case rests on its own expected use, distinct meaning, and visual identity.

Other Information

The singular name Kidney is concise and searchable even though the example shows the familiar paired organs. Vendors may vary color, shading, and plumbing detail while preserving two inward-facing kidney forms, a visible vertical offset, and short central vessel and ureter cues. Full vascular anatomy and fine detail are intentionally omitted for legibility at 18x18.

Official Unicode proposal guidance:

<https://www.unicode.org/emoji/proposals.html>